have been targeted, but also Buddhists have been subjected to violence" (BBC 2013). And when finally asked pointedly whether she condemned the anti-Muslim violence, she replied that, "I condemn any movement that is based on hatred and extremism" (BBC 2013).

Over the next few days, Suu Kyi was heavily criticized by the Western media for supposedly defending Buddhist extremism. *Daily Telegraph* reporter David Blair said that the interview had "sent a shiver down my spine" and that her attitudes toward Muslims were "deeply disturbing" (Blair 2013). Others described the interview as a "fall from grace" from the democracy icon (4News). One commentator even suggested that Suu Kyi should now be "shunned by the international community" (4News). While this condemnation was focused specifically on Aung San Suu Kyi, it was representative of a shift that was also taking place in the attitudes of the international aid community toward the democracy movement.

Previously, like Suu Kyi, democracy activists and opposition leaders had been considered allies of Western aid organizations' interests in the country. Yet this perception shifted dramatically with the contrasting reactions to reports of violence against Muslims. A Western donor representative interviewed for this research summed it up by saying that the international aid community "has never felt further from the Burmese democracy movement" (Interview 27, 2013 English).[1] The lack of sympathy for Muslim communities and the failure of some activists to condemn violence was seen as "extremely disappointing" (Interview 3, 2013 English). And a number of international aid workers said they were shocked to hear the way some local activists — many of whom they had known for some time — responded.

This chapter asks the question, *why have there been such contrasting reactions to the communal violence?* Many Western aid agencies and aid workers have been long-term supporters and allies of the Burmese democracy movement.[2] Why then has there been such a diversity of reactions between actors who supposedly have the same goal of "democracy"?

In this chapter I use a narrative approach to argue that different reactions to these incidents of communal violence are embedded within varied accounts of the country's democratization. Based on field research in 2013 and 2014, I argue that the starkly contrasting reactions are not a surprising anomaly amidst a wider consensus about what democratization means. Rather, they are windows onto broader differences in the way challenges and democratic visions for the country are constructed. "Democracy" in